“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 17

The Tortoise Form in Ecstasy, and the Ravings of Madness

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. Mahāprabhu was overcome by the madness of love (*premonmāda*) in many different forms. This chapter describes how one night, without opening the doors, He passed over three walls and fell among the cows from Tailaṅga, having taken the shape of a tortoise.

*A description of Gaura's[7] transcendental pastimes, heard from the mouth of the guru by the path of *śrauta* —*

লিখ্যতে শ্রীল-গৌরেন্দোরত্যদ্ভুতমলৌকিকম্ ।
যৈর্দৃষ্টং তন্মুখাচ্ছ্রুত্বা দিব্যোন্মাদ-বিচেষ্টিতম্ ॥ ১ ॥

likhyate śrīla-gaurendor
is described of Śrīla Gauracandra
aty-adbhutam alaukikam
most wonderful unearthly
yair dṛṣṭaṁ tan-mukhāc chrutvā
by whom seen from their mouths having heard
divyonmāda-viceṣṭitam
of divine madness the conduct

1 From the lips of those who saw them with their own eyes I have heard of the most wonderful, unearthly deeds of Śrīla Gauracandra in His divine madness, and now I describe them.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I write of the most wonderful, unearthly acts of Śrī Gauracandra in His divine madness only after hearing of them from the mouths of those who saw them with their own eyes.

Anubhāṣya.

yaiḥ (by the most fortunate intimate devotees headed by Dāmodara and Raghunātha) **śrīla-gaurendoḥ** (of Gauracandra) **adbhutam** (never heard of before) **alaukikam** (never seen before) **divyonmāda-viceṣṭitam** (the conduct of one maddened by *mahābhāva*) **dṛṣṭam** (was seen with their own eyes), **tan-mukhāt** (from the holy mouths of those very *śrī-gurus* who sang of it) **tat śrutvā** (having heard it, [by me]) **likhyate** (is described).

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory to Gaura's devotees host

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

*The Lord's madness (*unmāda*) and incoherent words (*pralāpa*) —*

এইমত মহাপ্রভু রাত্রি-দিবসে ।
উন্মাদের চেষ্টা, প্রলাপ করে প্রেমাবেশে ॥ ৩ ॥

ei-mata mahāprabhu rātri-divase
in this way Mahāprabhu night and day
unmādera ceṣṭā, pralāpa kare premāveśe
of madness the behaviour ravings makes absorbed in love

3 In this way, night and day, Mahāprabhu, absorbed in love, behaved like one mad and spoke in ravings.

The Lord's constant companions at that time —

একদিন প্রভু স্বরূপ-রামানন্দ-সঙ্গে ।
অর্দ্ধরাত্রি গোঙাইলা কৃষ্ণকথা-রঙ্গে ॥ ৪ ॥

eka-dina prabhu svarūpa-rāmānanda-saṅge
one day the Lord Svarūpa Rāmānanda with
ardha-rātri goṅāilā kṛṣṇa-kathā-raṅge
half the night passed of Kṛṣṇa talks in the delight

4 One day the Lord passed half the night with Svarūpa and Rāmānanda, delighting in talks about Kṛṣṇa.

Svarūpa serves the Lord with songs suited to His feelings —

যবে যেই ভাব প্রভু করয়ে উদয় ।
ভাবানুরূপ গীত গায় স্বরূপ-মহাশয় ॥ ৫ ॥

yabe yei bhāva prabhu karaye udaya
when whatever feeling the Lord makes arise
bhāvānurūpa gīta gāya svarūpa-mahāśaya
to the feeling suited a song sings Svarūpa Mahāśaya

5 Whatever feeling arose in the Lord, Svarūpa Mahāśaya would sing a song to suit it.

Rāya recites verses from books dear to the Lord —

বিদ্যাপতি, চণ্ডীদাস, শ্রীগীতগোবিন্দ ।
ভাবানুরূপ শ্লোক পড়েন রায়-রামানন্দ ॥ ৬ ॥

vidyāpati, caṇḍīdāsa, śrī-gīta-govinda
Vidyāpati Caṇḍīdāsa the Śrī Gīta-govinda
bhāvānurūpa śloka paḍena rāya-rāmānanda
to the feeling suited verses recites Rāya Rāmānanda

6 And Rāya Rāmānanda would recite verses suited to His feelings from Vidyāpati, Caṇḍīdāsa and the *Śrī Gīta-govinda*.

The Lord Himself recites verses and speaks words of lament —

মধ্যে মধ্যে আপনে প্রভু শ্লোক পড়িয়া ।
শ্লোকের অর্থ করেন প্রভু বিলাপ করিয়া ॥ ৭ ॥

madhye madhye āpane prabhu śloka paḍiyā
now and then Himself the Lord a verse reciting
ślokera artha karena prabhu vilāpa kariyā
of the verse the meaning makes the Lord lament making

7 Now and then the Lord would Himself recite a verse and, lamenting, explain its meaning.

Having put the Lord to bed, the two depart —

এইমতে নানাভাবে অর্দ্ধরাত্রি হৈল ।
গোসাঞিরে শয়ন করাই' দুঁহে ঘরে গেল ॥ ৮ ॥

ei-mate nānā-bhāve ardha-rātri haila
in this way in various feelings half the night passed
gosāñire śayana karāi' dum̐he ghare gela
the Lord to bed having put the two home went

8 So, amid many feelings, half the night went by. Then the two put the Lord to bed and went home.

*The Lord loudly chants the holy name (*nāma-saṅkīrtana*) —*

গম্ভীরার দ্বারে গোবিন্দ করিলা শয়ন ।
অর্দ্ধরাত্রিতে প্রভু করেন উচ্চসঙ্কীর্ত্তন ॥ ৯ ॥

gambhīrāra dvāre govinda karilā śayana
of the Gambhīrā at the door Govinda made his bed
ardha-rātrite prabhu karena ucca-saṅkīrtana
at midnight the Lord makes loud saṅkīrtana

9 Govinda lay down to sleep at the door of the Gambhīrā, and at midnight the Lord began to chant the holy names aloud.

The Lord's divine madness —

আচম্বিতে শুনেন প্রভু কৃষ্ণবেণু-গান ।
ভাবাবেশে প্রভু তাহাঁ করিলা প্রয়াণ ॥ ১০ ॥

ācambite śunena prabhu kṛṣṇa-veṇu-gāna
suddenly hears the Lord of Kṛṣṇa's flute the song
bhāvāveśe prabhu tāhāṁ karilā prayāṇa
absorbed in feeling the Lord there made departure

10 Suddenly the Lord heard the song of Kṛṣṇa's flute and, absorbed in feeling, set off towards it.

তিনদ্বারে কপাট ঐছে আছে ত' লাগিয়া ।
ভাবাবেশে প্রভু গেলা বাহির হঞা ॥ ১১ ॥

tina-dvāre kapāṭa aiche āche ta' lāgiyā
in the three doors the panels so are indeed fastened
bhāvāveśe prabhu gelā bāhira hañā
absorbed in feeling the Lord went outside becoming

11 The three doors stayed shut as they were, yet the Lord, lost in that feeling, passed outside.

সিংহদ্বার-দক্ষিণে আছে তৈলঙ্গী-গাভীগণ ।
তাঁহা যাই' পড়িলা প্রভু হঞা অচেতন ॥ ১২ ॥

siṁha-dvāra-dakṣiṇe āche tailaṅgī-gābhī-gaṇa
of the Siṁha-dvāra to the south are Tailaṅga cows the herd
tāṁhā yāi' paḍilā prabhu hañā acetana
there going fell the Lord becoming unconscious

12 To the south of the Siṁha-dvāra there was a herd of cows from Tailaṅga. The Lord went there and fell down unconscious.

Not hearing the Lord's voice, all search for Him and find Him —

এথা গোবিন্দ মহাপ্রভুর শব্দ না পাঞা ।
স্বরূপেরে বোলাইল কপাট খুলিয়া ॥ ১৩ ॥

ethā govinda mahāprabhura śabda nā pāñā
here Govinda of Mahāprabhu the sound not getting
svarūpere bolāila kapāṭa khuliyā
Svarūpa called the doors opening

13 Meanwhile Govinda, no longer hearing any sound from Mahāprabhu, opened the doors and called Svarūpa.

তবে স্বরূপ-গোসাঞি সঙ্গে লঞা ভক্তগণ ।
দেউটি জ্বালিয়া করেন প্রভুর অন্বেষণ ॥ ১৪ ॥

tabe svarūpa-gosāñi saṅge lañā bhakta-gaṇa
then Svarūpa Gosāñi with taking the devotees
deuṭi jvāliyā karena prabhura anveṣaṇa
torches lighting make for the Lord a search

14 Then Svarūpa Gosāñi took the devotees with him, and they lit torches and went in search of the Lord.

Anubhāṣya.
deuṭi — a lamp on a pole, a torch.

ইতি-উতি অন্বেষিয়া সিংহদ্বারে গেলা ।
গাভীগণ-মধ্যে যাই' প্রভুরে পাইলা ॥ ১৫ ॥

iti-uti anveṣiyā siṁha-dvāre gelā
here and there searching to the Siṁha-dvāra went
gābhī-gaṇa-madhye yāi' prabhure pāilā
of the cows among going the Lord found

15 After searching here and there, they went to the Siṁha-dvāra and found the Lord among the cows.

The Lord's condition —

পেটের ভিতর হস্ত-পদ — কূর্ম্মের আকার ।
মুখে ফেন, পুলকাঙ্গ, নেত্রে অশ্রুধার ॥ ১৬ ॥

peṭera bhitara hasta-pada — kūrmera ākāra
of the belly inside hands and feet of a tortoise the shape
mukhe phena, pulakāṅga, netre aśru-dhāra
in the mouth foam thrilled limbs in the eyes streams of tears

16 His hands and feet had drawn inside His body, and He had the shape of a tortoise. There was foam at His mouth, the hair of His body stood on end, and tears streamed from His eyes.

অচেতন পড়িয়াছেন, — যেন কুষ্মাণ্ড-ফল ।
বাহিরে জড়িমা, অন্তরে আনন্দ-বিহ্বল ॥ ১৭ ॥

acetana paḍiyāchena, — yena kuṣmāṇḍa-phala
unconscious is lying like a pumpkin fruit
bāhire jaḍimā, antare ānanda-vihvala
outside stupor within with bliss overwhelmed

17 He lay unconscious, like a great pumpkin: outwardly inert, but within overwhelmed with bliss.

গাভী সব চৌদিকে শুঁকে প্রভুর শ্রীঅঙ্গ ।
দূর কৈলে নাহি ছাড়ে প্রভুর শ্রীঅঙ্গ-সঙ্গ ॥ ১৮ ॥

gābhī saba caudike śuṁke prabhura śrī-aṅga
cows all on every side sniff the Lord's holy body
dūra kaile nāhi chāḍe prabhura śrī-aṅga-saṅga
away driven not leave the Lord's holy body's company

18 On every side the cows were sniffing the Lord's holy body; even when driven away, they would not leave His side.

The devotees try long to bring the Lord to consciousness and carry Him home —

অনেক করিলা যত্ন, না হয় চেতন ।
প্রভুরে উঠাঞা ঘরে আনিলা ভক্তগণ ॥ ১৯ ॥

aneka karilā yatna, nā haya cetana
much made effort not becomes conscious
prabhure uṭhāñā ghare ānilā bhakta-gaṇa
the Lord lifting home brought the devotees

19 The devotees tried hard to revive Him, but He did not regain consciousness. Then they lifted the Lord and carried Him home.

Loud saṅkīrtana brings the Lord to consciousness, and He returns to half-external consciousness —

উচ্চ করি' শ্রবণে করে নামসঙ্কীর্ত্তন ।
অনেকক্ষণে মহাপ্রভু পাইলা চেতন ॥ ২০ ॥

ucca kari' śravaṇe kare nāma-saṅkīrtana
loud making in the ears make of the name saṅkīrtana
aneka-kṣaṇe mahāprabhu pāilā cetana
after a long while Mahāprabhu regained consciousness

20 They sang the holy name loudly into His ears, and after a long while Mahāprabhu regained consciousness.

চেতন হইলে হস্ত-পাদ বাহিরে আইল ।
পূর্ব্ববৎ যথাযোগ্য শরীর হইল ॥ ২১ ॥

cetana haile hasta-pāda bāhire āila
conscious when He became hands and feet outside came
pūrvavat yathā-yogya śarīra haila
as before in proper proportion the body became

21 As He came to Himself, His hands and feet emerged again, and His body returned to its proper form, as before.

The Lord describes His state to Svarūpa —

উঠিয়া বসিলেন প্রভু, চাহেন ইতি-উতি ।
স্বরূপে কহেন, — তুমি আমা আনিলা কতি ? ॥ ২২ ॥

uṭhiyā vasilena prabhu, cāhena iti-uti
rising sat the Lord looks here and there
svarūpe kahena, — tumi āmā ānilā kati?
to Svarūpa says you Me have brought where

22 The Lord sat up and looked about Him. He said to Svarūpa, "Where have you brought Me?

বেণু-শব্দ শুনি' আমি গেলাঙ বৃন্দাবন ।
দেখি, — গোষ্ঠে বেণু বাজায় ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ॥ ২৩ ॥

veṇu-śabda śuni' āmi gelāṅa vṛndāvana
the flute's sound hearing I went to Vṛndāvana
dekhi, — goṣṭhe veṇu bājāya vrajendra-nandana
I see in the pasture the flute plays of the king of Vraja the son

23 Hearing the sound of the flute, I went to Vṛndāvana, and I saw the son of the king of Vraja playing His flute in the pasture.

সঙ্কেত-বেণু-নাদে রাধা গেলা কুঞ্জঘরে ।
কুঞ্জেরে চলিলা কৃষ্ণ ক্রীড়া করিবারে ॥ ২৪ ॥

saṅketa-veṇu-nāde rādhā gelā kuñja-ghare
of the signal of the flute at the call Rādhā went to the bower house
kuñjere calilā kṛṣṇa krīḍā karibāre
to the bower went Kṛṣṇa pastimes to make

24 At the signal call of His flute Rādhā went to the bower, and Kṛṣṇa too went there for His pastimes.

তাঁর পাছে পাছে আমি করিনু গমন ।
তাঁর ভূষণ-ধ্বনিতে আমার হরিল শ্রবণ ॥ ২৫ ॥

tāṁra pāche pāche āmi karinu gamana
Him behind behind I made going
tāṁra bhūṣaṇa-dhvanite āmāra harila śravaṇa
His ornaments' by the jingling My was stolen hearing

25 I followed close behind Him, and the jingling of His ornaments captivated My ears.

গোপীগণ-সহ বিহার, হাস, পরিহাস ।
কণ্ঠধ্বনি-উক্তি শুনি' মোর কর্ণোল্লাস ॥ ২৬ ॥

gopī-gaṇa-saha vihāra, hāsa, parihāsa
the gopīs with pastimes laughter jesting
kaṇṭha-dhvani-ukti śuni' mora karṇollāsa
voice's sound words hearing My ears' joy

26 Kṛṣṇa was enjoying His pastimes with the gopīs, laughing and jesting, and My ears rejoiced to hear His voice and His words.

হেনকালে তুমি সব কোলাহল করি' ।
আমা ইঁহা লঞা আইলা বলাৎকার করি' ॥ ২৭ ॥

hena-kāle tumi saba kolāhala kari'
at that time you all an uproar making
āmā iṁhā lañā āilā balātkāra kari'
Me here taking brought force using

27 Just then all of you raised an uproar and brought Me here by force.

The lament of the Lord, deprived of hearing Kṛṣṇa's sounds —

শুনিতে না পাইনু সেই অমৃতসম বাণী ।
শুনিতে না পাইনু ভূষণ-মুরলীর ধ্বনি ॥ ২৮ ॥

śunite nā pāinu sei amṛta-sama vāṇī
to hear not did I get those nectar like words
śunite nā pāinu bhūṣaṇa-muralīra dhvani
to hear not did I get of the ornaments of the flute the sound

28 I could no longer hear those words, sweet as nectar; I could no longer hear the jingling of His ornaments and the sound of His flute."

ভাবাবেশে স্বরূপে কহেন গদগদ-বাণী ।
'কর্ণ তৃষ্ণায় মরি, পড় 'রসামৃত' শুনি' ॥ ২৯ ॥

bhāvāveśe svarūpe kahena gadgada-vāṇī
absorbed in feeling to Svarūpa says choked words
'karṇa tṛṣṇāya mari, paḍa 'rasāmṛta' śuni'
My ears with thirst I die recite nectar of rasa I shall hear

29 Absorbed in feeling, the Lord said to Svarūpa in a choked voice, "My ears are dying of thirst. Recite something full of the nectar of rasa — let Me hear it."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
karṇa-tṛṣṇāya — from thirst to hear of Kṛṣṇa's qualities.

At Gaura's bidding, Svarūpa recites a verse —

স্বরূপ-গোসাঞি প্রভুর ভাব জানিয়া ।
ভাগবতের শ্লোক পড়ে মধুর করিয়া ॥ ৩০ ॥

svarūpa-gosāñi prabhura bhāva jāniyā
Svarūpa Gosāñi of the Lord the mood knowing
bhāgavatera śloka paḍe madhura kariyā
of the Bhāgavata a verse recites sweet making

30 Svarūpa Gosāñi, knowing the Lord's mood, sweetly recited a verse from the *Bhāgavata*:

The sweetness of Kṛṣṇa's flute enchants and attracts His servants of every kind

*— (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.29.40)*

কাস্ত্র্যঙ্গ তে কলপদামৃতবেণুগীত-
সম্মোহিতার্য্যচরিতান্ন চলেৎ ত্রিলোক্যাম্ ।
ত্রৈলোক্য-সৌভগমিদঞ্চ নিরীক্ষ্য রূপং
যদ্গোদ্বিজদ্রুমমৃগাঃ পুলকান্যবিভ্রন্ ॥ ৩১ ॥

kā stry aṅga te kala-padāmṛta-veṇu-gīta-
what woman O dear one Your of sweet words by the nectar of the flute by the song

sammohitārya-caritān na calet tri-lokyām
enchanted from the conduct of the noble not would stray in the three worlds

trailokya-saubhagam idaṁ ca nirīkṣya rūpaṁ
of the three worlds the beauty this and having seen form

yad go-dvija-druma-mṛgāḥ pulakāny abibhran
which cows birds trees deer thrills of rapture bore

31 "O Kṛṣṇa, what woman in the three worlds, enchanted by the song of Your flute with its sweet, nectarean notes, would not stray from the conduct of the noble? Seeing this form of Yours, the beauty of the three worlds, even cows, birds, trees and deer bristle with rapture." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.29.40)[1]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 24.52.

*The Lord, absorbed in the mood of the gopīs, speaks *citra-jalpa* —*

শুনি' প্রভু গোপীভাবে আবিষ্ট হইলা ।
ভাগবতের শ্লোকার্থ করিতে লাগিলা ॥ ৩২ ॥

śuni' prabhu gopī-bhāve āviṣṭa hailā
hearing the Lord in the mood of the gopīs absorbed became

bhāgavatera ślokārtha karite lāgilā
of the Bhāgavata the verse's meaning to make began

32 Hearing this, the Lord became absorbed in the mood of the gopīs and began to explain the meaning of the verse:

*A gopī describes her own feelings for Kṛṣṇa (*citra-jalpa*) — [Any *rāga* as suits (*yathā-rāga*)]*

হৈল গোপী-ভাবাবেশ, কৈল রাসে পরবেশ,
কৃষ্ণের শুনি' উপেক্ষা-বচন ।
কৃষ্ণের মুখ-হাস্য-বাণী, ত্যাগে তাহা সত্য মানি',
রোষে কৃষ্ণে দেন ওলাহন ॥ ৩৩ ॥

haila gopī-bhāvāveśa,
there was in the gopīs' mood absorption
kaila rāse praveśa,
made into the rāsa entry
kṛṣṇera śuni' upekṣā-vacana
Kṛṣṇa's hearing of disregard words
kṛṣṇera mukha-hāsya-vāṇī,
Kṛṣṇa's mouth's smiling words
tyāge tāhā satya māni',
as rejection them true taking
roṣe kṛṣṇe dena olāhana
in anger to Kṛṣṇa gives reproach

33 Immersed in that mood, He entered the rāsa dance. There He heard Kṛṣṇa, smiling, speak words of indifference, and, taking them for a true rejection, He reproached Kṛṣṇa in anger:

The explanation of the verse begins —

নাগর, কহ, তুমি করিয়া নিশ্চয় ।
এই ত্রিজগৎ ভরি', আছে যত যোগ্যা নারী,
তোমার বেণু কাঁহা না আকর্ষয়? ॥ ৩৪ ॥ধ্রু॥

nāgara, kaha, tumi kariyā niścaya
O lover say You making certain
ei trijagat bhari',
these three worlds filling
āche yata yogyā nārī,
there are as many worthy women
tomāra veṇu kāṁhā nā ākarṣaya?
Your flute whom not attracts

34 "O Beloved, tell us truly: of all the worthy women who fill the three worlds, which is not drawn by Your flute?

A description of the power of the flute's sweetness —

কৈলা জগতে বেণুধ্বনি, সিদ্ধমন্ত্রা যোগিনী,
দূতী হঞা মোহে নারী-মন ।
মহোৎকণ্ঠা বাড়াঞা, আর্য্যপথ ছাড়াঞা,
আনি' তোমায় করে সমর্পণ ॥ ৩৫ ॥

kailā jagate veṇu-dhvani,
You made in the world the flute's sound
siddha-mantrā yoginī,
of perfected mantras a yoginī
dūtī hañā mohe nārī-mana
a go-between becoming enchants women's minds
mahotkaṇṭhā bāḍāñā,
great longing increasing
ārya-patha chāḍāñā,
the noble path making them leave
āni' tomāya kare samarpaṇa
bringing to You makes offering

35 You sent the sound of Your flute into the world, and like a *yoginī* perfect in her mantras, it becomes a go-between and enchants the minds of women. It swells their longing, makes them forsake the path of the noble, and delivers them to You.

The transcendental young Madana, or Kāmadeva Anaṅga —

ধর্ম্ম ছাড়ায় বেণুদ্বারে, হানে কটাক্ষ-কামশরে,
লজ্জা, ভয়, সকল ছাড়ায় ৷
এবে আমায় করি' রোষ, কহি' পতি ত্যাগে 'দোষ',
ধার্ম্মিক হঞা ধর্ম্ম শিখাও ॥ ৩৬ ॥

dharma chāḍāya veṇu-dvāre,
dharma You make them leave by the flute
hāne kaṭākṣa-kāma-śare,
You strike of glances of Kāma with the arrows
lajjā, bhaya, sakala chāḍāya
shame fear all You make them leave
ebe āmāya kari' roṣa,
now at us making anger
kahi' pati tyāge 'doṣa',
saying husbands in leaving a fault
dhārmika hañā dharma śikhāo
righteous becoming dharma You teach

36 With Your flute You make us abandon dharma; You strike us with the arrows of Kāma, Your sidelong glances, and make us cast off shame and fear and everything else. And now You are angry with us, You say it is wrong to leave our husbands, and, like a man of virtue, You teach us dharma!

অন্যকথা, অন্যমন, বাহিরে অন্য আচরণ,
এই সব শঠ-পরিপাটী ৷
তুমি জান পরিহাস, হয় নারীর সর্ব্বনাশ,
ছাড় এই সব কুটীনাটী ॥ ৩৭ ॥

anya-kathā, anya-mana,
other words other mind
bāhire anya ācaraṇa,
outwardly other conduct
ei saba śaṭha-paripāṭī
this all of a cheat the artifices
tumi jāna parihāsa,
You know jest
haya nārīra sarva-nāśa,
is women's utter ruin
chāḍa ei saba kuṭīnāṭī
give up these all tricks

37 Your words say one thing, Your mind another, and outwardly You act in yet another way — all these are the artifices of a cheat. For You it is a jest, but for women it is utter ruin. Give up all these tricks!

বেণুনাদ অমৃত-ঘোলে, অমৃত-সমান মিঠা বোলে,
অমৃত-সমান ভূষণ-শিঞ্জিত।
তিন অমৃতে হরে কাণ, হরে মন, হরে প্রাণ,
কেমনে নারী ধরিবেক চিত ? ॥ ৩৮ ॥

veṇu-nāda amṛta-ghole,
the flute's sound nectar outdoes
amṛta-samāna miṭhā bole,
nectar equal sweet words
amṛta-samāna bhūṣaṇa-śiñjita
nectar equal the ornaments' jingling
tina amṛte hare kāṇa,
by the three nectars steals the ears
hare mana, hare prāṇa,
steals the mind steals the life
kemane nārī dharibeka cita?
how a woman will hold her heart

38 The sound of Your flute outdoes nectar; Your sweet words are like nectar, and the jingling of Your ornaments is like nectar too. With these three nectars You steal our ears, You steal our minds, You steal our very life. How can a woman keep hold of her heart?”[2]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Absorbed in their feeling, the gopīs entered the *rāsa-līlā*. There they heard Kṛṣṇa’s words of disregard (*upekṣā-vacana*), that is, His indifferent words, and took it as true that Kṛṣṇa had rejected them. So they speak to Kṛṣṇa in anger: “O lover (*nāgara*), tell us: is there any worthy woman in the three worlds whom Your flute does not attract? When You play Your flute in this world, its sound, like a *yoginī* who has mastered mantras and the like, becomes a go-between (*dūtī*) and enchants (allures) the minds of women. It greatly increases their longing, makes them abandon the path enjoined by the Vedas (serving their husbands, elders, and others), and delivers them to You (in the mood of *parakīyā* beloveds). With Your flute and with the arrows of Kāma — Your glances — You pierced us, made us give up the path of dharma, shame, and fear, and brought us to You. You Yourself made us leave our husbands and so on, and now You point out to us that this is a sin and, like a righteous man, teach us dharma! In Your mind is one thing, in Your words another, and in Your conduct a third. All this is the skilled trickery of a cheat (mere cunning). To You it is only a jest, but for a woman it is utter ruin. So give up all this deceit. First, the sound of the flute is nectarean buttermilk; on top of that, sweet words — the nectar of speech; and on top of that, a nectarean sound [of ornaments]. These three nectars together steal our ears, mind, and life.”

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

śiñjita — sound.

Anubhāṣya.

ghole — in colloquial speech, *ghol khāoyāy* (“makes one drink buttermilk”), that is, eclipses or overcomes. A variant reading is *role*, that is, by its sound, by its noise; another variant is *ugāre*, “pours forth.”

In the mood of Rādhā the Lord relishes Kṛṣṇa's sweetness —

এত কহি' ক্রোধাবেশে, ভাবের তরঙ্গে ভাসে,
উৎকণ্ঠা-সাগরে ডুবে মন ।
রাধার উৎকণ্ঠা বাণী, পড়ি' আপনে বাখানি,
কৃষ্ণমাধুর্য্য করে আস্বাদন ॥ ৩৯ ॥

eta kahi' krodhāveśe,
so much saying absorbed in anger
bhāvera taraṅge bhāse,
of feeling on the waves floats
utkaṇṭhā-sāgare ḍube mana
of longing in the ocean sinks the mind
rādhāra utkaṇṭhā vāṇī,
Rādhā's longing words
paḍi' āpane vākhāni,
reciting Himself explaining
kṛṣṇa-mādhurya kare āsvādana
Kṛṣṇa's sweetness makes tasting

39 Having said this in anger, He floated on the waves of feeling, and His mind sank into an ocean of longing. Then He recited the words of Rādhā in Her yearning and, explaining them Himself, tasted the sweetness of Kṛṣṇa:

Madana-mohana, sweetness embodied —

নদজ্জলদনিস্বনঃ শ্রবণকর্ষিসচ্ছিঞ্জিতঃ
সনর্ম্মরসসূচকাক্ষরপদার্থভঙ্গ্যুক্তিকঃ ।
রমাদিক-বরাঙ্গনা-হৃদয়হারি-বংশীকলঃ
স মে মদনমোহনঃ সখি তনোতি কর্ণস্পৃহাম্ ॥ ৪০ ॥

nadaj-jalada-nisvanaḥ śravaṇa-karṣi-sac-chiñjitaḥ
of a thundering cloud whose voice the ears drawing lovely jingling
sanarma-rasa-sūcakākṣara-padārtha-bhaṅgy-uktikaḥ
of jest rasa hinting syllables words meanings artful speech
ramādika-varāṅganā-hṛdaya-hāri-vaṁśī-kalaḥ
of Ramā and the others of the fairest women the hearts stealing of the flute the soft note
sa me madana-mohanaḥ sakhi tanoti karṇa-spṛhām
He My Madana-mohana O friend increases of the ears the longing

40 "O friend, His voice is like the rumbling of a thundercloud; the lovely jingling of His ornaments draws the ear; in the artful turns of His speech every syllable, word and meaning is playful and hints at rasa; and the soft note of His flute steals the hearts of Lakṣmī and other lovely women. That Madana-mohana of Mine deepens the longing of My ears." (Govinda-līlāmṛta, 8.5)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O friend! His voice is deep like a cloud; the sound of His ornaments draws the ears; His playful words are full of artful turns (*bhaṅgī*); the sound of His flute draws the hearts of Lakṣmī and other women. This Madana-mohana increases the longing of My ears.

Anubhāṣya.

he sakhi, **nadaj-jalada-nisvanaḥ** (He whose deep voice is like the rumble [*nisvana*] of a thundering cloud [*jalada*]) **śravaṇa-karṣi-sac-chiñjitaḥ** (He whose ornaments make a beautiful, most sweet tinkling whose nature is to draw the ears of the *gopīs*) **sanarma-rasa-sūcakākṣara-padārtha-bhaṅgy-uktikaḥ** (He whose speech is full of an artful arrangement [*bhaṅgī*, *paripāṭī*] of the meanings of words, in syllables that hint at rasa and are filled with jest [*narma*]) **ramādika-varāṅganā-hṛdaya-hārī-vaṁśī-kalaḥ** (He the sound [*kala*] of whose flute steals, that is, draws, the hearts of the finest women, headed by Lakṣmī) **madana-mohanaḥ me** (My) **karṇa-spṛhām** (longing to hear) **tanoti** (increases).

The meaning of the verse; the sweetness of Kṛṣṇa's voice described —

কণ্ঠের গম্ভীর ধ্বনি, নবঘন-ধ্বনি জিনি',
যার গুণে কোকিল লাজায়।
তার এক শ্রুতি-কণে, ডুবায় জগতের কাণে,
পুনঃ কাণ বাহুড়ি' না আয় ॥ ৪১ ॥

kaṇṭhera gambhīra dhvani,
of the voice deep sound
navaghana-dhvani jini',
of a new cloud the rumbling conquering
yāra guṇe kokila lājāya
whose by the quality the cuckoo is put to shame
tāra eka śruti-kaṇe,
of it one of hearing by a drop
ḍubāya jagatera kāṇe,
drowns of the world the ears
punaḥ kāṇa bāhuḍi' nā āya
again the ears returning not come

41 "The deep sound of His voice conquers the rumbling of a new cloud, and its sweetness puts the cuckoo to shame. Even a single drop of it, entering the ear, drowns the ears of the world, and those ears never come back again.

কহ, সখি, কি করি উপায় ?
কৃষ্ণের সে শব্দ-গুণে, হরিলে আমার কাণে,
এবে না পায়, তৃষ্ণায় মরি' যায় ॥ ৪২ ॥ধ্রু॥

kaha, sakhi, ki kari upāya?
tell O friend what shall I do means
kṛṣṇera se śabda-guṇe,
of Kṛṣṇa that sound's by the qualities
harile āmāra kāṇe,
were stolen My ears
ebe nā pāya, tṛṣṇāya mari' yāya
now not get of thirst dying go

42 Tell Me, O friend, what shall I do? The charms of that sound of Kṛṣṇa's stole My ears, and now, deprived of it, they are dying of thirst.

The sweetness of the tinkling of Kṛṣṇa's ankle bells described —

নূপুর-কিঙ্কিণী-ধ্বনি, হংস-সারস জিনি',
কঙ্কণ-ধ্বনি চটকে লাজায় !
একবার যেই শুনে, ব্যাপি' রহে তার কাণে,
অন্যশব্দ সে কাণে না যায় ॥ ৪৩ ॥

nūpura-kiṅkiṇī-dhvani,
of the anklets of the waist-bells the sound
haṁsa-sārasa jini',
of swans and cranes conquering
kaṅkaṇa-dhvani caṭake lājāya!
the bracelets' sound the caṭaka birds puts to shame
eka-bāra yei śune,
once whoever hears
vyāpi' rahe tāra kāṇe,
pervading stays in his ears
anya-śabda se kāṇe nā yāya
another sound into those ears not goes

43 The sound of the bells on His ankles and waist conquers the cries of swans and cranes, and the jingling of His bracelets puts the *caṭaka* birds to shame. Once anyone hears it, it fills his ears and stays there, and no other sound can enter them again.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
caṭaka — a particular bird.

The sweetness of Kṛṣṇa's words described —

সে শ্রীমুখ-ভাষিত, অমৃত হৈতে পরামৃত,
স্মিত-কর্পূর তাহাতে মিশ্রিত ।
শব্দ, অর্থ, — দুইশক্তি, নানা-রস করে ব্যক্তি,
প্রত্যক্ষর — নর্ম্ম-বিভূষিত ॥ ৪৪ ॥

se śrī-mukha-bhāṣita,
those holy mouth's words
amṛta haite parāmṛta,
nectar than higher nectar
smita-karpūra tāhāte miśrita
of the smile the camphor in them mixed
śabda, artha, — dui-śakti,
sound meaning two powers
nānā-rasa kare vyakti,
various rasas make manifest
pratyakṣara — narma-vibhūṣita
every syllable with jest adorned

44 The words of His holy mouth are a nectar higher than nectar, and the camphor of His smile is mixed into them. Their two powers, sound and meaning, bring out every kind of rasa, and every syllable is adorned with jest.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
śabda, artha — dui śakti: *abhidhā* (the direct sense) and *lakṣaṇā* (the figurative sense) are the two powers of the word; of these, ornaments of meaning (*arthālaṅkāra*) and the like are the power of meaning.

সে অমৃতের এক-কণ, কর্ণ-চকোর-জীবন,
কর্ণ-চকোর জীয়ে সেই আশে ৷
ভাগ্যবশে কভু পায়, অভাগ্যে কভু না পায়,
না পাইলে মরয়ে পিয়াসে ॥ ৪৫ ॥

se amṛtera eka-kaṇa,
that of nectar one drop
karṇa-cakora-jīvana,
of the ears the cakora the life
karṇa-cakora jīye sei āśe
of the ears the cakora lives on that hope
bhāgya-vaśe kabhu pāya,
by fortune sometimes gets
abhāgye kabhu nā pāya,
by misfortune sometimes not gets
nā pāile maraye piyāse
not getting dies of thirst

45 One drop of that nectar is the very life of the *cakora* bird of the ears, and on the hope of it alone that *cakora* lives. Sometimes, by good fortune, it gets that drop; sometimes, by ill fortune, it goes without, and then it dies of thirst.

The sweetness of the sound of the flute described —

যেবা বেণু-কলধ্বনি, একবার তাহা শুনি',
জগন্নারী-চিত্ত আউলায় ৷
নীবি-বন্ধ পড়ে খসি', বিনা-মূলে হয় দাসী,
বাউলী হঞা কৃষ্ণ-পাশে ধায় ॥ ৪৬ ॥

yebā veṇu-kala-dhvani,
which the flute's sweet sound
eka-bāra tāhā śuni',
once it hearing
jagan-nārī-citta āulāya
of the world the women's hearts are thrown into turmoil
nīvi-bandha paḍe khasi',
the sash knots fall slipping loose
vinā-mūle haya dāsī,
without price become maidservants
bāulī haññā kṛṣṇa-pāśe dhāya
crazed becoming to Kṛṣṇa's side run

46 Let the women of the world hear but once the sweet sound of His flute, and their hearts are thrown into turmoil. The knots of their sashes slip loose; they become His unbought maidservants and, as if crazed, run to Kṛṣṇa's side.

Even Lakṣmī longs to relish Kṛṣṇa's sweetness, but cannot —

যেবা লক্ষ্মী-ঠাকুরাণী, তেঁহো যে কাকলী শুনি',
কৃষ্ণ-পাশ আইসে প্রত্যাশায় ।
না পায় কৃষ্ণের সঙ্গ, বাড়ে তৃষ্ণা-তরঙ্গ,
তপ করে, তবু নাহি পায় ॥ ৪৭ ॥

yebā lakṣmī-ṭhākurāṇī,
even Lakṣmī the goddess
teṁho ye kākalī śuni',
she that soft song hearing
kṛṣṇa-pāśa āise pratyāśāya
to Kṛṣṇa's side comes in hope
nā pāya kṛṣṇera saṅga,
not gets Kṛṣṇa's company
bāḍe tṛṣṇā-taraṅga,
grow of thirst the waves
tapa kare, tabu nāhi pāya
austerity performs still not gets

47 Even the goddess Lakṣmī, hearing that soft song, comes to Kṛṣṇa in hope. But she does not obtain Kṛṣṇa's company; the waves of her thirst only swell, and though she performs austerities, she still does not attain Him.

Ears that do not serve Kṛṣṇa condemned —

এই শব্দামৃত চারি, যার হয় ভাগ্য ভারি,
সেই কর্ণে ইহা করে পান ।
ইহা যেই নাহি শুনে, সে কাণ জন্মিল কেনে,
কাণাকড়ি-সম সেই কাণ ॥ ৪৮ ॥

ei śabdāmṛta cāri,
these sound-nectars four
yāra haya bhāgya bhāri,
whose is fortune great
sei karṇe ihā kare pāna
he with his ears this makes drinking
ihā yei nāhi śune,
this who not hears
se kāṇa janmila kene,
those ears were born why
kāṇākaḍi-sama sei kāṇa
a cracked cowrie like those ears

48 Only one whose fortune is great drinks these four nectars of sound with his ears. As for one who does not hear them — why were such ears ever born? They are no better than a cracked cowrie shell."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The deep sound of His voice reigns, having conquered the rumbling of a new cloud; His sweet singing puts the cuckoo to shame. When even the smallest particle of it enters the ears, it so submerges (overpowers) the world's "ears," that is, all other sounds, that those "ears" can never come back.[4] O friend, the virtues of that sound of Kṛṣṇa have stolen My ears, and now, deprived of it, I must die of thirst. The tinkling of the bells on His ankles and waist defeats the voices of swans and *sārasa* cranes, and the jingling of His bracelets puts the *caṭaka* bird to shame. Whoever lets that sound into his ears even once allows no other sound to enter them.

The sweetness of Kṛṣṇa's words is a nectar surpassing even nectar, and the camphor of His smile is mixed into it as well. His words convey (*vyañjanā*) the power of the word (*śabda-śakti*), the power of meaning (*artha-śakti*) and the various *rasas*, beginning with *śṛṅgāra*, and every syllable of them is adorned with *narma*, that is, jest. A single drop (*bindu*) of that nectar is the very life of the *cakora* bird of the ears; on the hope of it alone the *cakora* of the ears lives. Sometimes by good fortune it gets that drop, sometimes by misfortune it does not, and when it does not, it lies at death's door from thirst.

Once the women of the world hear the sweet sound of His flute, their minds lose all hold (grow slack), the knots of their sashes come loose, and they become His maid-

servants without any price and run to Kṛṣṇa like madwomen. Lakṣmī-ṭhākurāṇī, hearing His soft song (*kākalī*), comes to Kṛṣṇa in hope. But she does not obtain Kṛṣṇa's company, and the waves of her thirst[5] swell. In that hope she performs austerities, yet even so she cannot obtain Kṛṣṇa.

These four kinds of nectar of sound — His words, the tinkling of His anklets and bracelets, the sound of His voice and the sound of His flute — enter only the ears of the fortunate. For one whose ears this fourfold nectar of sound has not entered, those ears were born in vain: like a cracked cowrie shell, they are worthless.

*The mingling of emotions (*bhāva-śābalya*) in the Lord —*

করিতে ঐছে বিলাপ, উঠিল উদ্বেগ, ভাব,
মনে কাহো নাহি আলম্বন ।
উদ্বেগ, বিষাদ, মতি, ঔৎসুক্য, ত্রাস, ধৃতি, স্মৃতি,
নানা-ভাবের হইল মিলন ॥ ৪৯ ॥

karite aiche vilāpa,
making such lament
uṭhila udvega, bhāva,
arose agitation feeling
mane kāho nāhi ālambana
in the mind any no support
udvega, viṣāda, mati,
agitation despondency resolve
autsukya, trāsa, dhṛti, smṛti,
eagerness fear steadiness remembrance
nānā-bhāvera haila milana
of various feelings there was a meeting

49 As He lamented in this way, agitation and other feelings arose in Him, and His mind had nothing to hold on to. Agitation, despondency, resolve, eagerness, fear, steadiness and remembrance — so many feelings came together in Him at once.

The madness of separation from Kṛṣṇa —

ভাবশাবল্যে রাধার উক্তি, লীলাশুকে হৈল স্ফূর্ত্তি,
সেই ভাবে পড়ে এক শ্লোক ।
উন্মাদের সামর্থ্যে, সেই শ্লোকের করে অর্থে,
যেই অর্থ নাহি জানে লোক ॥ ৫০ ॥

bhāva-śābalye rādhāra ukti,
in the mixture of feelings Rādhā's words
līlā-śuke haila sphūrti,
in Līlāśuka was revealed
sei bhāve paḍe eka śloka
in that feeling recites one verse
unmādera sāmarthye,
of madness by the power
sei ślokera kare arthe,
that verse's makes meaning
yei artha nāhi jāne loka
which meaning not know people

50 Rādhā's words, spoken in such a mixture of feelings, had been revealed to Līlāśuka. In that same mood the Lord recited one of his verses and, by the power of His divine madness, drew out a meaning that people do not know:[3]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Līlāśuka — Bilvamaṅgala Gosvāmī.

Anubhāṣya.
A variant reading: *Līlāsukha*.

Śrī Rādhā's words —

কিমিহ কৃণুমঃ কস্য ব্রূমঃ কৃতং কৃতমাশয়া
কথয়ত কথামন্যাং ধন্যামহো হৃদয়েশয়ঃ ।
মধুরমধুরস্মেরাকারে মনোনয়নোৎসবে
কৃপণকৃপণা কৃষ্ণে তৃষ্ণা চিরং বত লম্বতে ॥ ৫১ ॥

kim iha kṛṇumaḥ kasya brūmaḥ kṛtaṁ kṛtam āśayā
what here shall we do to whom shall we speak done is done in hope
kathayata kathām anyāṁ dhanyām aho hṛdaye śayaḥ
speak talk other auspicious alas in the heart lying
madhura-madhura-smerākāre mano-nayanotsave
in the sweetest sweet smiling form of mind and eyes the festival
kṛpaṇa-kṛpaṇā kṛṣṇe tṛṣṇā ciraṁ bata lambate
wretched most wretched for Kṛṣṇa thirst ever longer alas grows

51 "What are we to do now? To whom can we speak? What was done in hope of Him is done. Speak of something else, something auspicious. Ah, but He lies in My heart! For Kṛṣṇa — the festival of mind and eyes, whose smiling form is sweeter than the sweetest — My wretched, most wretched thirst, alas, grows ever longer." (Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta, 42)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Alas, what shall I do! And whom shall I tell! What I did in the hope of Him — let it end there; now speak of something else, something auspicious (*dhanya*, good). For He Himself (as Kāma) has lain down in My heart — how then can I give up talk of Him? Towards Kṛṣṇa — the embodiment of the sweetest of sweet smiles, a festival for the mind and eyes — My thirst, full of humility (wretched), keeps growing all the time.

Anubhāṣya.
he sakhyaḥ (O friends), (**tat**) **iha** (in this calamity, separation, *vipralambha*) **kiṁ kṛṇumaḥ** (what shall we do so that He may be seen?) **kasya brūmaḥ** (for you too are in the same state) **tasya**[8] **āśayā** (in the hope of attaining Kṛṣṇa) **yat kṛtam** (what was done, performed), **tat kṛtam**; **anyāṁ kām api dhanyāṁ** (auspicious) **kathāṁ kathayata**; **aho** (what pain!) **hṛdaye śayaḥ** (Kāma, the enemy, dwells in My heart and so cannot be cast out; it is he who is killing Me — what can we do?)

bata (alas) **madhura-madhura-smerākāre** (in Him whose form is sweeter than sweetness itself, smiling and blossoming with the rapture of Madana and the like) **mano-nayanotsave** (in Him who gives a festival to the mind and eyes) **kṛṣṇe kṛpaṇa-kṛpaṇā** (wretched, more wretched than the wretched, sorely distressed with longing) **tṛṣṇā ciram** (incessantly) **lambate** (grows).

The meaning of the verse; how Śrīmatī suffers in separation from Kṛṣṇa described —

এই কৃষ্ণের বিরহে, উদ্বেগে মন স্থির নহে,
প্রাপ্ত্যুপায়-চিন্তন না যায় ৷
যেবা তুমি সখীগণ, বিষাদে বাউল মন,
কারো পুছোঁ, কে কহে উপায় ? ॥ ৫২ ॥

ei kṛṣṇera virahe,
this of Kṛṣṇa in separation
udvege mana sthira nahe,
from agitation the mind steady is not
prāpty-upāya-cintana nā yāya
of attaining the means thinking of not goes
yebā tumi sakhī-gaṇa,
and you friends
viṣāde bāula mana,
with despondency crazed mind
kāro puchoṁ, ke kahe upāya?
whom shall I ask who will tell the means

52 "In this separation from Kṛṣṇa My mind is so agitated that it cannot be still, and I cannot think how to attain Him. And you, My friends — your minds too are crazed with despondency. Whom shall I ask? Who will tell Me the way?

হাহা সখি, কি করি উপায় !
ক্যা করোঁ কাঁহা যাঙ, কাঁহা গেলে কৃষ্ণ পাঙ,
কৃষ্ণ বিনা প্রাণ মোর যায় ॥ ৫৩ ॥

hā hā sakhi, ki kari upāya!
alas alas O friend what shall I do means
kyā karoṁ kāṁhā yāṅa,
what shall I do where shall I go
kāṁhā gele kṛṣṇa pāṅa,
where going Kṛṣṇa shall I find
kṛṣṇa vinā prāṇa mora yāya
Kṛṣṇa without life My goes

53 Alas, alas, O friend, what shall I do? What can I do, where can I turn? Where must I go to find Kṛṣṇa? Without Kṛṣṇa My life is leaving Me."

The longing to give up hope, and praise of it —

ক্ষণে মন স্থির হয়, তবে মনে বিচারয়,
বলিতে হইল ভাবোদ্গম ৷
পিঙ্গলার বচন-স্মৃতি, করাইল ভাব-মতি,
তাতে করে অর্থ-নির্দ্ধারণ ॥ ৫৪ ॥

kṣaṇe mana sthira haya,
for a moment the mind steady becomes
tabe mane vicāraya,
then in the mind considers
balite haila bhāvodgama
speaking there was a feeling's rising
piṅgalāra vacana-smṛti,
Piṅgalā's words' remembrance
karāila bhāva-mati,
brought about a feeling resolve
tāte kare artha-nirdhāraṇa
by that makes of the meaning determination

54 For a moment His mind became steady, and He reflected. But as soon as He began to speak, a new feeling arose: the remembrance of Piṅgalā's words brought Him to a resolve, and in that mood He settled the meaning of the verse:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

piṅgalāra vacana-smṛti — the courtesan Piṅgalā said: "Hope is the greatest misery; giving up hope is the greatest happiness."[6] Remembering those words, the Lord awakened through them a new feeling within Himself and began to determine the meaning of the verse.

Anubhāṣya.

For the story of Piṅgalā, see *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.8.22–44 and the *Mahābhārata*: the *Mokṣa-dharma-parva* within the *Śānti-parva*, chapter 174.

The attempt to forget Kṛṣṇa —

দেখি এই উপায়ে, কৃষ্ণ-আশা ছাড়ি' দিয়ে,
আশা ছাড়িলে সুখী হয় মন ।
ছাড়ি' কৃষ্ণকথা অধন্য, কহ অন্যকথা ধন্য,
যাতে হয় কৃষ্ণ-বিস্মরণ ॥ ৫৫ ॥

dekhi ei upāye,
I see this means
kṛṣṇa-āśā chāḍi' diye,
for Kṛṣṇa hope I shall give up
āśā chāḍile sukhī haya mana
hope giving up happy becomes the mind
chāḍi' kṛṣṇa-kathā adhanya,
leaving of Kṛṣṇa talk inauspicious
kaha anya-kathā dhanya,
speak other talk auspicious
yāte haya kṛṣṇa-vismaraṇa
whereby is of Kṛṣṇa forgetting

55 "I see only this way: I will give up My hope for Kṛṣṇa. Once hope is gone, the mind is happy. Leave this inauspicious talk of Kṛṣṇa and speak of something else, something auspicious, so that I may forget Him."

Kṛṣṇa, as the transcendental Kāmadeva, takes possession of the heart —

কহিতেই হৈল স্মৃতি, চিত্তে হৈল কৃষ্ণস্ফূর্ত্তি,
সখীরে কহে হঞা বিস্মিতে ।
যারে চাহি ছাড়িতে, সে শুঞা আছে চিত্তে,
কোন রীতে না পারি ছাড়িতে ॥ ৫৬ ॥

kahitei haila smṛti,
even as She spoke there was remembrance
citte haila kṛṣṇa-sphūrti,
in the heart there was Kṛṣṇa's manifestation
sakhīre kahe hañā vismite
to the friend says becoming astonished
yāre cāhi chāḍite,
whom I want to give up
se śuñā āche citte,
He lying is in the heart
kona rīte nā pāri chāḍite
by any way not can I give up

56 But even as She spoke, She remembered Him, and Kṛṣṇa appeared in Her heart. In astonishment She told Her friend, "He whom I want to forsake lies in My heart, and try as I may, I cannot let Him go."

রাধাভাবের স্বভাব আন, কৃষ্ণে করায় 'কাম'-জ্ঞান,
কাম-জ্ঞানে ত্রাস হৈল চিত্তে ।
কহে — যে জগৎ মারে, সে পশিল অন্তরে,
এই বৈরী না দেয় পাসরিতে ॥ ৫৭ ॥

rādhā-bhāvera svabhāva āna,
of Rādhā's feeling the nature is other
kṛṣṇe karāya 'kāma'-jñāna,
in Kṛṣṇa makes of Kāma the perception
kāma-jñāne trāsa haila citte
in the perception of Kāma fear arose in the heart
kahe — ye jagat māre,
says who the world strikes down
se paśila antare,
he has entered within
ei vairī nā deya pāsarite
this enemy not lets forget

57 Such is the wondrous nature of Rādhā's feeling that it made Her see Kṛṣṇa as Kāmadeva, and at that thought Her heart was seized with fear. She said, "He who strikes down the whole world has entered My heart. This enemy will not let Me forget Him."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
kṛṣṇe karāya 'kāma'-jñāna — makes one see Kṛṣṇa as Kandarpa.

Anubhāṣya.
māre — "Māra": that is, He conquers in the form of Kāmadeva.

Eager longing for Kṛṣṇa —

ঔৎসুক্যের প্রাধান্য, জিনি' অন্য ভাব-সৈন্য,
উদয় হৈল নিজ-রাজ্য মনে ।
মনে হইল লালস, না হয় আপন-বশ,
দুঃখে মনে করেন ভর্ৎসনে ॥ ৫৮ ॥

autsukyera prādhānya,
of eagerness the supremacy
jini' anya bhāva-sainya,
conquering other feelings' armies
udaya haila nija-rājya mane
rising there was in its own kingdom in the mind
mane haila lālasa,
in the mind there was craving
nā haya āpana-vaśa,
not is under her own control
duḥkhe mane karena bhartsane
in sorrow the mind She makes reproaches

58 Then eagerness, conquering the armies of all the other feelings, rose to supremacy in its own kingdom, Her mind. Craving seized that mind, and, no longer mistress of Herself, She reproached it in sorrow:

Śrīmatī wholly in Kṛṣṇa's power —

মন মোর বাম-দীন, জল বিনা যেন মীন,
কৃষ্ণ বিনা ক্ষণে মরি' যায় ।
মধুর-হাস্য-বদনে, মন-নেত্র-রসায়নে,
কৃষ্ণতৃষ্ণা দ্বিগুণ বাড়ায় ॥ ৫৯ ॥

mana mora vāma-dīna,
mind My wayward wretched
jala vinā yena mīna,
water without like a fish
kṛṣṇa vinā kṣaṇe mari' yāya
Kṛṣṇa without in a moment dying goes
madhura-hāsya-vadane,
sweet smiling by the face
mana-netra-rasāyane,
of mind and eyes the elixir
kṛṣṇa-tṛṣṇā dviguṇa bāḍāya
for Kṛṣṇa thirst twofold increases

59 “My mind is wayward and wretched. Like a fish without water, without Kṛṣṇa it dies in an instant. And Kṛṣṇa’s sweetly smiling face, the elixir of mind and eyes, makes My thirst for Him twice as great.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

vāma-dīna — wretched because of contrariness (*vāmya*). The thirst for Kṛṣṇa, whose sweetly smiling face is an elixir (*rasāyana*) for the mind and eyes, doubles.

Lament in separation from Kṛṣṇa —

হা হা কৃষ্ণ প্রাণধন, হা হা পদ্মলোচন,
হা হা দিব্য সদ্গুণ-সাগর !
হা হা শ্যামসুন্দর, হা হা পীতাম্বরধর,
হা হা রাসবিলাস নাগর ! ॥ ৬০ ॥

hā hā kṛṣṇa prāṇa-dhana,
alas alas Kṛṣṇa of life the treasure
hā hā padma-locana,
alas alas lotus-eyed
hā hā divya sad-guṇa-sāgara!
alas alas divine of virtues ocean
hā hā śyāma-sundara,
alas alas Śyāmasundara
hā hā pītāmbara-dhara,
alas alas yellow cloth wearing
hā hā rāsa-vilāsa nāgara!
alas alas of the rāsa pastimes lover

60 Alas, Kṛṣṇa, treasure of My life! Alas, lotus-eyed one! Alas, divine ocean of virtues! Alas, Śyāmasundara! Alas, You who wear yellow cloth! Alas, Beloved, playful hero of the rāsa dance!

Absorbed in the mood of Rādhā in separation, the Lord runs —

কাঁহা গেলে তোমা পাই, তুমি কহ, — তাঁহা যাই,
এত কহি' চলিলা ধাঞা ৷
স্বরূপ উঠি' কোলে করি', প্রভুরে আনিল ধরি',
নিজস্থানে বসাইলা লৈঞা ॥ ৬১ ॥

kāṁhā gele tomā pāi,
where going You shall I find
tumi kaha, — tāṁhā yāi,
You say there I shall go
eta kahi' calilā dhāñā
so much saying went running
svarūpa uṭhi' kole kari',
Svarūpa rising in his arms taking
prabhure ānila dhari',
the Lord brought holding
nija-sthāne vasāilā laiñā
in His own place seated taking

61 Where must I go to find You? Tell Me, and I will go there!" Saying this, the Lord ran off. But Svarūpa rose, caught Him in his arms, brought Him back and seated Him in His own place.

Through Svarūpa's efforts the Lord regains consciousness; Svarūpa sings songs suited to His mood —

ক্ষণেকে প্রভুর বাহ্য হৈল, স্বরূপেরে আজ্ঞা দিল,
স্বরূপ, কিছু কর মধুর গান ৷
স্বরূপ গায় বিদ্যাপতি, গীতগোবিন্দ-গীতি,
শুনি' প্রভুর জুড়াইল কাণ ॥ ৬২ ॥

kṣaṇeke prabhura bāhya haila,
in a moment of the Lord outer consciousness came
svarūpere ājñā dila,
to Svarūpa an order gave
svarūpa, kichu kara madhura gāna
Svarūpa something make sweet song
svarūpa gāya vidyāpati,
Svarūpa sings Vidyāpati
gīta-govinda-gīti,
of the Gīta-govinda songs
śuni' prabhura juḍāila kāṇa
hearing the Lord's were soothed ears

62 In a moment the Lord came back to outer consciousness and said to Svarūpa, "Svarūpa, sing something sweet." Svarūpa sang songs of Vidyāpati and of the *Gīta-govinda*, and the songs soothed the Lord's ears.

*The Lord's *mahābhāva* — divine madness and the rest — is beyond the measure of the mortal mind —*

এইমত মহাপ্রভু প্রতিরাত্রি-দিনে ।
উন্মাদ-চেষ্টিত হয় প্রলাপ-বচনে ॥ ৬৩ ॥

ei-mata mahāprabhu prati-rātri-dine
in this way Mahāprabhu every night and day
unmāda-ceṣṭita haya pralāpa-vacane
of madness the behaviour is in raving words

63 In this way, every night and day, Mahāprabhu behaved like one mad and spoke in ravings.

একদিনে যত হয় ভাবের বিকার ।
সহস্র-মুখে বর্ণে যদি, নাহি পায় পার ॥ ৬৪ ॥

eka-dine yata haya bhāvera vikāra
in one day as many as are of feeling transformations
sahasra-mukhe varṇe yadi, nāhi pāya pāra
with a thousand mouths describes if not reaches the end

64 Even if one with a thousand mouths were to describe all the transformations of feeling that arose in Him in a single day, he could not reach their end.

জীব দীন কি করিবে তাহার বর্ণন ?
শাখা-চন্দ্র-ন্যায় করি' দিগ্দরশন ॥ ৬৫ ॥

jīva dīna ki karibe tāhāra varṇana?
a jīva lowly what will make of it description
śākhā-candra-nyāya kari' dig-daraśana
of the branch and the moon by the logic I make an indication

65 What can a lowly jīva like me describe of it? As one shows the moon by pointing to a branch, I give only an indication.

Anubhāṣya.
Even Anantadeva, who has infinite power, cannot with His thousand mouths describe the pastimes of Śrī Gaurāṅga — His acts in divine madness. I am a wretched, powerless and utterly incapable jīva, and so I cannot describe the pastimes of Gaura fully. Even so, to point out the direction, I have relied only on the maxim of the moon on the branch (*śākhā-candra-nyāya*).

Whoever hears of the Lord's divine madness awakens to the truth of prema —

ইহা যেই শুনে, তার জুড়ায় মন-কাণ ।
অলৌকিক গূঢ়প্রেম-চেষ্টা হয় জ্ঞান ॥ ৬৬ ॥

ihā yei śune, tāra juḍāya mana-kāṇa
this whoever hears his are soothed mind and ears
alaukika gūḍha-prema-ceṣṭā haya jñāna
unearthly secret love's workings becomes knowledge

66 Whoever hears this finds his mind and ears soothed and comes to know the unearthly workings of hidden love.

In the mood of Śrīmatī the Lord Himself relishes love for Kṛṣṇa and distributes it to the jīvas —

অদ্ভুত নিগূঢ় প্রেমের মাধুর্য্য-মহিমা ।
আপনি আস্বাদি' প্রভু দেখাইলা সীমা ॥ ৬৭ ॥

adbhuta nigūḍha premera mādhurya-mahimā
wonderful most secret of love the sweetness' glory
āpani āsvādi' prabhu dekhāilā sīmā
Himself tasting the Lord showed the limit

67 The Lord Himself tasted the wondrous sweetness of that most secret love in all its glory, and showed its utmost limit.

The supremely magnanimous giver of love for Kṛṣṇa —

অদ্ভুত দয়ালু চৈতন্য — অদ্ভুত-বদান্য ।
ঐছে দয়ালু দাতা লোকে নাহি শুনি অন্য ॥ ৬৮ ॥

adbhuta dayālu caitanya — adbhuta-vadānya
wonderfully merciful Caitanya wonderfully generous
aiche dayālu dātā loke nāhi śuni anya
such merciful a giver in the world not we hear another

68 Caitanya is wonderfully merciful, wonderfully generous! We have never heard of another giver in this world so merciful.

Only by worshipping Caitanya does one attain love for Kṛṣṇa —

সর্ব্বভাবে ভজ, লোক, চৈতন্য-চরণ ।
যাহা হৈতে পাইবা কৃষ্ণপ্রেমামৃত-ধন ॥ ৬৯ ॥

sarva-bhāve bhaja, loka, caitanya-caraṇa
with all the heart worship O people Caitanya's feet
yāhā haite pāibā kṛṣṇa-premāmṛta-dhana
which from you will get for Kṛṣṇa of love of the nectar the treasure

69 O people, worship the feet of Caitanya with all your heart! From them you will receive a treasure — the nectar of love for Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.
sarva-bhāve — wholly, exclusively.

*The Lord's divine madness (*udghūrṇā* and *citra-jalpa*) described —*

এই ত' কহিলুঁ প্রভুর 'কূর্ম্মাকৃতি'-ভাব ।
উন্মাদ-চেষ্টিত তাতে উন্মাদ-প্রলাপ ॥ ৭০ ॥

ei ta' kahiluṁ prabhura 'kūrmākṛti'-bhāva
this indeed I have told of the Lord of the tortoise form the state
unmāda-ceṣṭita tāte unmāda-pralāpa
of madness the behaviour in it of madness ravings

70 Thus I have told how the Lord, in ecstasy, took the form of a tortoise, how He acted in His divine madness, and what ravings He uttered.

Raghunātha described this pastime of the Lord in his own book —

এই লীলা স্বগ্রন্থে রঘুনাথ-দাস ।
চৈতন্যস্তবকল্পবৃক্ষে কৈরাছেন প্রকাশ ॥ ৭১ ॥

ei līlā sva-granthe raghunātha-dāsa
this pastime in his own book Raghunātha dāsa
caitanya-stava-kalpa-vṛkṣe kairāchena prakāśa
in the Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa has described

71 Raghunātha dāsa has described this pastime in his own book, the *Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa*:

অনুদঘাট্য দ্বারত্রয়মুরু চ ভিত্তিত্রয়মহো
বিলঙ্ঘ্যাচ্চৈঃ কালিঙ্গিক-সুরভিমধ্যে নিপতিতঃ ।
তনূদ্যৎসঙ্কোচাৎ কমঠ ইব কৃষ্ণোরুবিরহাদ্
বিরাজন্ গৌরাঙ্গো হৃদয় উদয়ন্মাং মদয়তি ॥ ৭২ ॥

anudghāṭya dvāra-trayam uru ca bhitti-trayam aho
not opening of doors the three high and of walls the three ah
vilaṅghyoccaiḥ kāliṅgika-surabhi-madhye nipatitaḥ
crossing over high of Kaliṅga the cows among fallen
tanūdyat-saṅkocāt kamaṭha iva kṛṣṇoru-virahād
from the body's arising contraction a tortoise like from Kṛṣṇa great from separation
virājan gaurāṅgo hṛdaya udayan māṁ madayati
shining Gaurāṅga in my heart rising me maddens

72 "Ah! Without opening the three doors, He passed high over the three tall walls and fell among the cows of Kaliṅga. Through His great separation from Kṛṣṇa His body contracted, and He appeared like a tortoise. That Gaurāṅga, rising in my heart, makes me mad with joy." (Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa, 5)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Without the three bolted doors being opened, He came out of that room, crossed three walls and fell among the Tailaṅga cows. His whole body contracted, and in separation from Kṛṣṇa He took the shape of a tortoise. That Śrī Gaurāṅgadeva, rising in my heart, maddens me.

Thus ends the seventeenth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.

aho, (in Kāśī Miśra's house) **dvāra-trayam anudghāṭya** (without unbolting) **uru** (high) **bhitti-trayam** (three walls) **ca uccaiḥ vilaṅghya** (crossing over) **kāliṅgika-surabhi-madhye** (among cows born in the land of Kaliṅga, within Trailaṅga) **nipatitaḥ kṛṣṇoru-virahāt** (from severe separation from Kṛṣṇa) **tanūdyat-saṅkocāt** (from the contraction, that is, the shrinking, that arose in His body) **kamaṭhaḥ** (a tortoise) **iva virājan gaurāṅgaḥ mama hṛdaye udayan mām madayati** (fills with bliss).

Where the Godāvarī River meets the sea stood the capital of the land of Tailaṅga, “Kariṅga,” or “Dakṣiṇa-Kaliṅga” (South Kaliṅga). In Sanskrit a Tailaṅga cow is called *kāliṅgika-surabhi*.

Thus ends the seventeenth chapter of the “Anubhāṣya.”

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ৭৩ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa’s, Raghunātha’s at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
“Caitanya-caritāmṛta” narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

73 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Madhya 24.52; translation as there. ↩
2. In other editions (variant readings noted in the *Anubhāṣya*) — *role*, “with the sound”, and *ugāre*, “pours forth”. ↩
3. In other editions (as noted in the *Anubhāṣya*) — “Līlāsukha”. ↩
4. The verse translation reads differently: even a single drop of it, entering the ear, drowns the ears of the world, and those ears never come back again (for Bhaktivinoda, the “ears” here are the other sounds of the world). ↩
5. The edition reads *tṛṣṇā-raṅga* (“the play of thirst”); verse 47 has *tṛṣṇā-taraṅga* (“the waves of thirst”); apparently a misprint. ↩
6. Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.8.44. ↩
7. The edition reads «গৌড়ের» (“of Gauḍa”); the sense (verse 1 speaks of Gauracandra) calls for «গৌরের» (“of Gaura”). ↩
8. In the edition the word *tasya* (“His”) stands inside the bracketed gloss; by sense it goes with **āśayā** (“in the hope of Him”). ↩